

Leisure & Recreation

THE EVERYTHING SPACE

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PROBLEM IDENTIFICATION & IDEATION

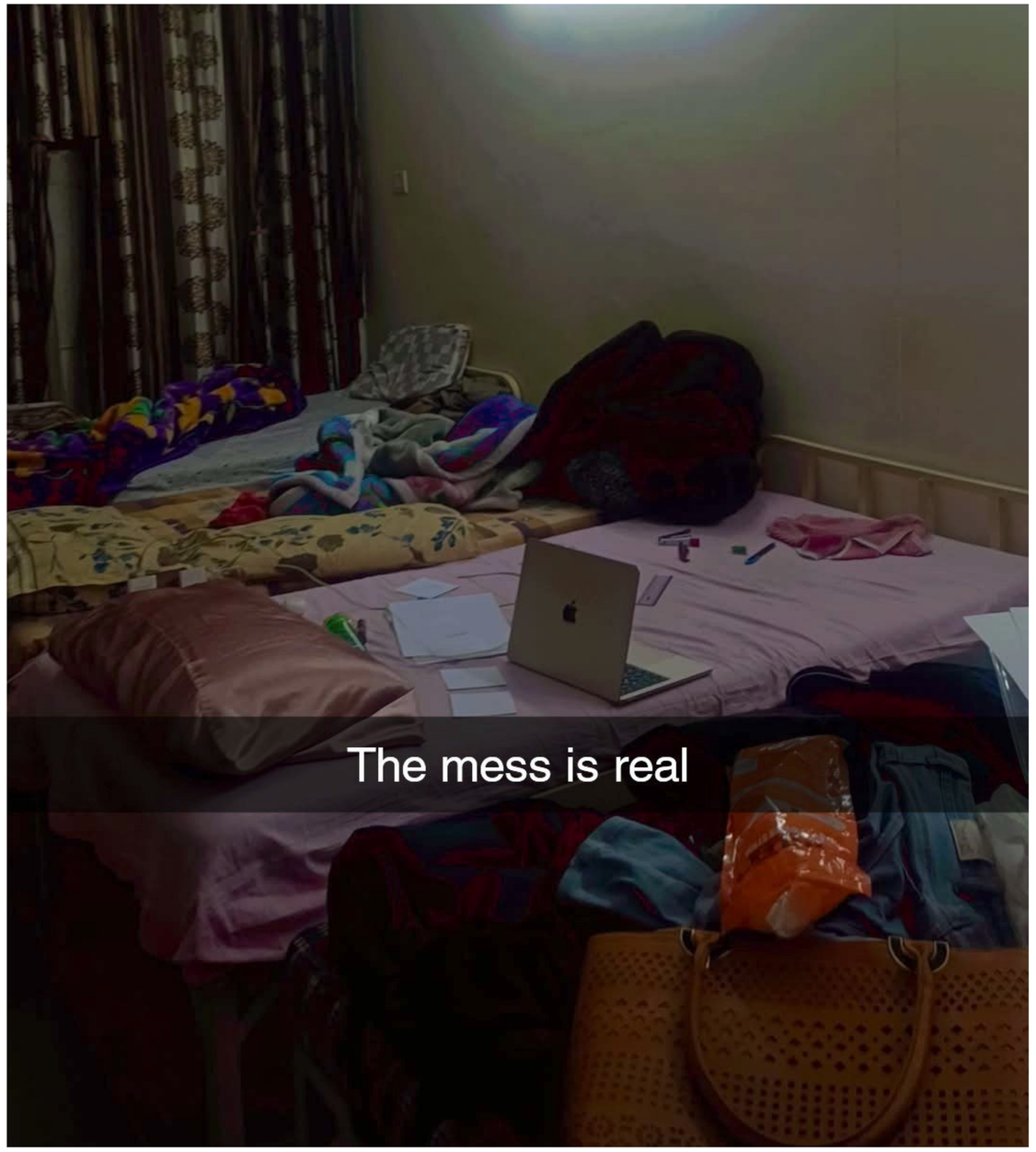
Topic Selection · Brainstorming · Mind Mapping · Keyword Analysis · Affinity Mapping

01

Topic

Leisure & Recreation

How the bed became the primary site for BOTH work and rest in urban Indian living, collapsing the boundary between rest and stimulation.



Source: Chakrabarti, V. (2021). "The Architecture of Density: Living in Urban India."

KEY TERMS

Bed-centric lifestyle

Boundary blurring

Conditional arousal

Revenge procastination

Dopamine habit

Transition loss

Spatial loss

Commute loss



The bed is now associated with high stress and high dopamine simultaneously

functioning as office, cinema, dining room, and social space, ***all at once.***

Source: Kroese, F. M., et al. (2014). "Bedtime procrastination: A self-regulation problem." Frontiers in Psychology.

Mind Mapping

Leisure & Recreation — Full Landscape of Activities

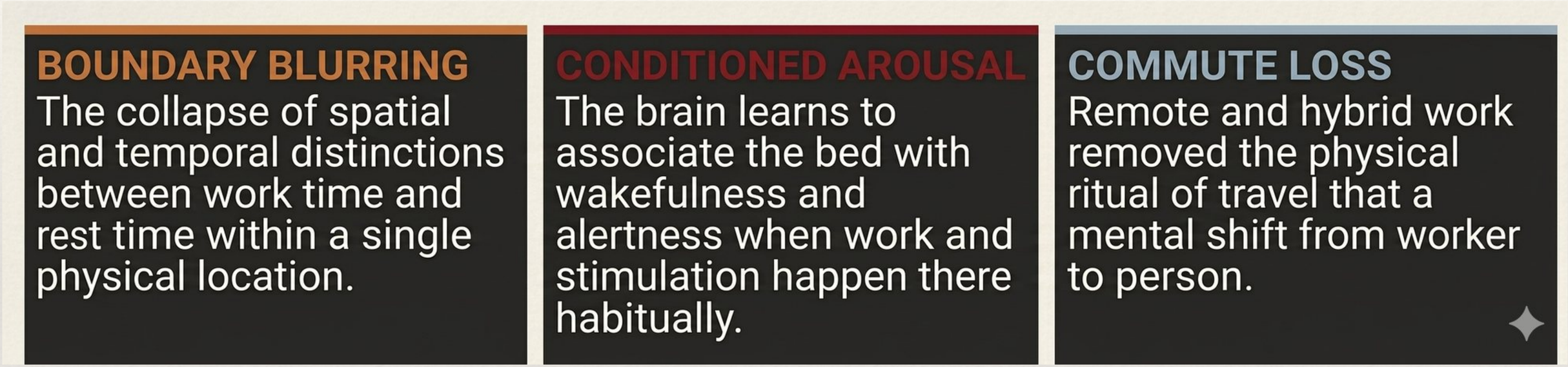


MUSIC	DOOMSCROLLING	SLEEP
Mood	Instagram	Duration
Devices	YouTube	Naps
Genres	Shopping	Journaling
Live events	Triggers	Meditation
Creation	Anxiety	Tools

BINGE EATING	CAFÉ HOPPING	SELF-CARE
Mood	Type	Skincare
Food type	Purpose	Yoga
Comfort	Timing	Journaling
Triggers	Social	Breathing
Night snacks	Study	Exercise

Keyword Analysis

The central phenomenon: using bed as the default location for work, rest, entertainment and social activity.



Source: Stepanski, E. J., & Wyatt, J. K. (2003). "Use of stimulus control instructions and relaxation training in the treatment of insomnia." *Sleep Medicine Reviews*.

Source: Giurge, L. M., & Bohns, V. K. (2020). "3 Tips to Avoid WFH Burnout." *Harvard Business Review*.

Source: Spagnol, S. (2020). "The Bed as the New Office: How the Pandemic Changed Our Spatial Habits." *Journal of Interior Design*. (Or similar industry reports on post-pandemic interior trends).

REVENGE BEDTIME PROCRASTINATION

Staying up late on the phone as the only form of personal autonomy available in a day controlled by obligations.

TRANSITION LOSS

The disappearance of the psychological buffer — formerly the commute — that once separated work identity from rest identity.

DOPAMINE HABIT

Short-term reward loops from scrolling, binge eating, and content consumption that make the behaviour compulsive.

SPATIAL CONSTRAINT

Urban India's average 117 sq ft of personal space makes the bed the only viable private territory for most users.

Four Clusters: Sticky-Note Mapping Session

HOW WE DID IT

- **STEP 1: GATHER**

All nine researchers independently noted observations about leisure and bed behavior on individual sticky notes. No filtering, no editing, ***raw honest observations only.***

- **STEP 2: PLACE**

Every note was placed on a shared board without discussion. Overlapping ideas were placed near each other naturally, letting spatial proximity reveal early patterns.

- **STEP 3: CLUSTER**

The team silently moved notes into groups that felt connected. ***Clusters emerged organically***, no labels were assigned until the grouping felt stable.

- **STEP 4 : NAME**

Once the four major clusters solidified, the team voted on the label that best described the theme. Names were kept broad enough to hold all notes within them.

- **STEP 5: ANALYSE**

Each cluster was interrogated: What is the underlying driver? What does this tell us about the user? Which cluster is most surprising? Which has the most notes?

Affinity Mapping

FOUR CLUSTERS

01 EFFECT ON HEALTH

The largest cluster. Covers all physical and psychological consequences of bed-centric living — neck pain, insomnia, fatigue, eye strain, anxiety, circadian disruption, and metabolic risk. Notes here were not primarily about what people do on the bed, but what the bed does to them over

02 INSTANT GRATIFICATION

Captures the dopamine economy of bed-based leisure — doomscrolling, binge eating, fast content, impulsive shopping, and compulsive phone checking. Notes reflected awareness that these felt good in the moment but worse afterwards. The compulsive quality was noted by almost every researcher

03 ENVIRONMENT

All notes related to the physical and spatial conditions that force or enable bed-centric behaviour. Small rooms, shared living, no desk, no private zone, landlord restrictions, lighting defaults, and the lack of any designed transition signal. The environment is not neutral — it actively pushes people toward

04 SELF-IMPROVEMENT

The smallest but most interesting cluster. Notes here showed that people do attempt healthier alternatives — journaling, skincare, meditation, reading, exercise — but these compete against the weight of all other clusters. Awareness exists. Follow-through does not.

Key Insight: People are aware of healthier alternatives, they just rarely practice them. Awareness ≠ Action

Patterns Identified Across All Sticky Notes

EFFECTS ON HEALTH

- Neck & Shoulder Pain
- Lower back aches
- Eye strain
- Jaw Tension
- Chronic fatigue
- Sleep-onset anxiety
- Circadian disruption
- Metabolic risk

INSTANT GRATIFICATION

- Doomscrolling loops
- Binge eating
- Fast content
- Shopping triggers
- Short-term dopamine
- FOMO
- Compulsive checking
- Reward habituation

ENVIRONMENT

- 117 sq ft average space
- No private zone
- Shared homes
- Bed as only territory
- No desk alternative
- Sensory control
- Landlord restrictions
- Lighting defaults

SELF-IMPROVEMENT

- Journaling attempts
- Skincare routine
- Meditation
- Reading
- Online courses
- Exercise guilt
- Healthy snack
- Open-air

PROBLEM STATEMENT

“The bed-centric lifestyle blurs boundaries between work, sleep, and leisure, affecting sleep quality and mental well-being. (Ages 18-40)”

The Deeper Problem

The brain does not register this as rest because the environment has not changed. This creates a cycle of insomnia, low alertness, fatigue, and no true recovery, a cognitive behavioural problem.





RESEARCH & ANALYSIS

Secondary Research · Market Research · Case Studies · Trend Analysis · Competitor Analysis

16+ Academic & Industry Sources · 220 Survey Responses · 12 In-Depth Interviews

02

The Market is Not Solving the Problem — It is Accelerating

$277B

Global bedding market projected by 2033 — smart beds, over-mattress desks, padded headboards, built-in screens.

59%

Increase in insomnia and metabolic risk documented from extended bed-centric living.

83%

IT professionals facing burnout from 11–13 hour work days — many now conducted from bed.

117 sq ft

Average personal space per person in urban India. The bed is the only viable private workspace.

74%

College students classified as poor sleepers, with bed-based screen use as primary contributing factor.



What the Data Reveals

THE NUMBERS

$277B
market by 2033

59% Insomnia & metabolic risk

83% IT professionals with burnout

117sq ft
space in India

74% College students poor sleepers

220 Responses collected

Trend Analysis

BED ROTTING

The Gen Z ‘self-care’ trend

- Begins as relaxation → tips into reality avoidance.
- Increases cortisol via fast-paced content.
- Neurologically disruptive despite 'wellness' label.
- Market frames sedentary bed use as self-care.
- Users are largely convinced this is healthy.
- TikTok & Instagram have normalised 'bed days’.



What Exists — and Why It's Not Enough

SMART BEDS	OVER-MATTRESS DESKS	ERGONOMIC HEADBOARDS
Adjustable surfaces, app-controlled environment, sleep tracking. Optimises bed use, does NOT create transition.	Foldable tables that rest on the mattress for laptop use. Makes bed-working more comfortable.	Padded, adjustable. Engineered for all- day sitting in bed. Treats symptom not cause.

MEDITATION APPS	ROOM DIVIDERS	LIGHTING APPS
Calm, Headspace. Require discipline to use. No physical environment change.	Fabric screens. Require space + permission. Not viable for 117 sq ft.	Night Shift, Screen-only warm light. Doesn't address behaviour loop.

Primary Research — Methodology

Mixed Methods:

- 220 Survey Responses
- 12 Interviews

SURVEY

· 220 responses · Branched questions · Living situation segmentation · Diagnosis scoring from INTACT to CRITICAL

IN-DEPTH INTERVIEWS

· 12 participants · Ages 18–40 ·Hostel, family home, rented room, working professional contexts

GROUP OBSERVATION

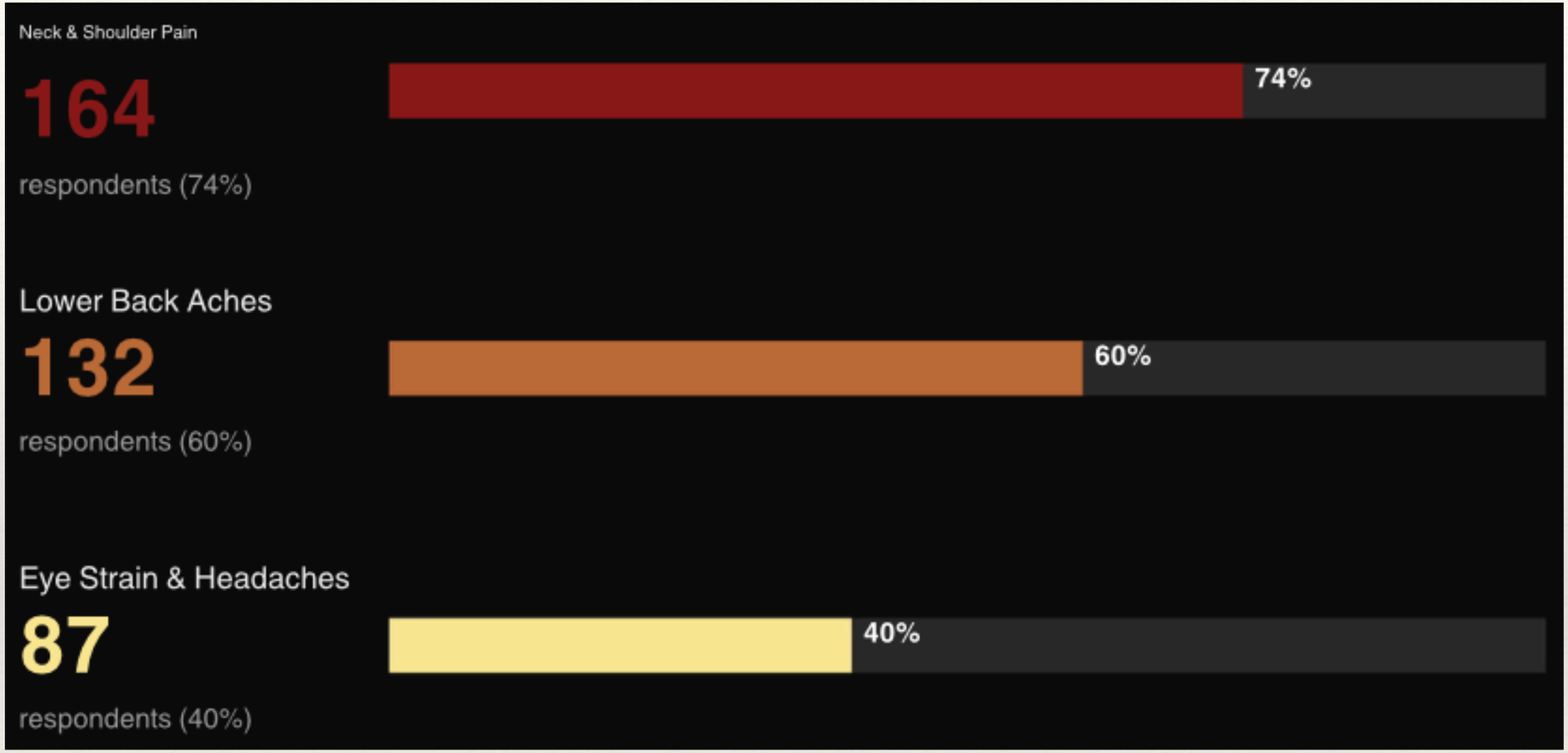
· Large-format sketch session ·Leisure habits mapped visually — sleep, scrolling, food, music, family time

SECONDARY RESEARCH

· 9 researchers · 16+ sources ·SpringerLink, NIH, Stanford, Gallup, McKinsey, Sleep Journal 2024

Survey Data

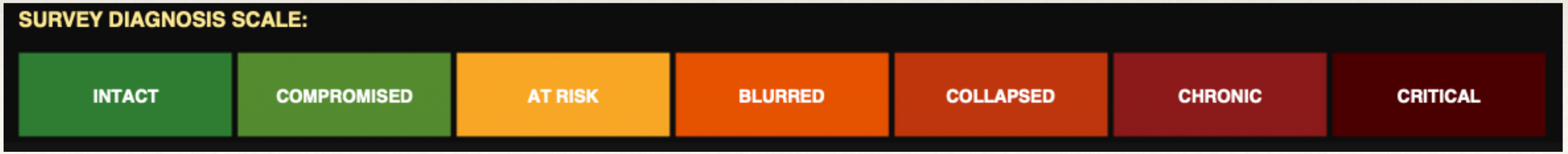
SURVEY — PHYSICAL SYMPTOMS · n = 220

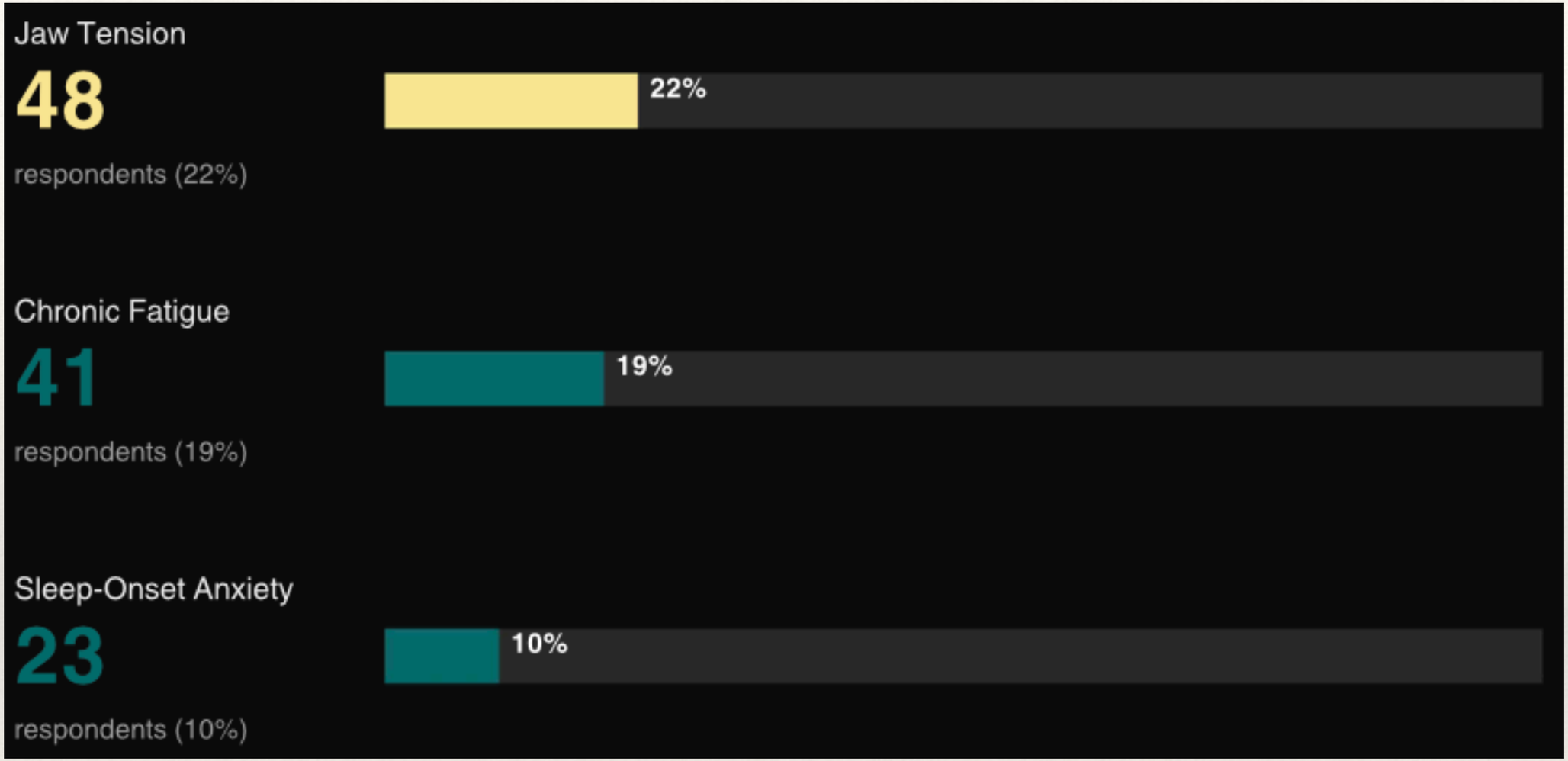


What the Body is Telling Us?

KEY FINDING

14 students reported 3+ physical symptoms but attributed them to **'general life stress'**, not bed behaviour.





SURVEY DIAGNOSIS SCALE:

INTACT	COMPROMISED	AT RISK	BLURRED	COLLAPSED	CHRONIC	CRITICAL

Patterns That Appeared Regardless of Age, Gender, or Living Situation

UNIVERSAL ACROSS ALL 12 INTERVIEWS

“The bed is the only privately owned territory in a shared environment.”

AWARENESS-ACTION GAP

"Every interviewee acknowledged being more productive at a desk — but chose the bed for comfort anyway. "

BEHAVIOURAL LOOP

"Doomscrolling was described as unwanted but compulsive.”

COMFORT OVER COGNITION

"I know I should move to the desk. I just... don't."

SPATIAL INEVITABILITY

"The bed absorbs every function by default when no spatial alternative exists."

CORE EMOTIONAL DRIVER

In a day structured by external obligations, sleeping at night is my only autonomy.

Beyond the Obvious

- **GENDER**

Women in shared Indian homes face a triple burden: work, domestic labour, caregiving. The bedroom becomes social escape, not just spatial necessity. Design must acknowledge this gendered dimension.

- **NEURODIVERGENCE**

~22%of the population finds the bedroom's sensory controllability the most functional workspace. The quiet, the texture, the familiar, it works for them. Design must not erase this need.

- **MENTAL HEALTH**

Depression may cause bed retreat before bed-working begins. The causal chain runs both ways, not just from habit to illness, but from illness to habit. Any intervention must be aware of this.

- **LIGHTING**

Fixed cool-white LEDs signal alertness all day. A shift to warm amber at end-of-day can function as a designed commute replacement, at near-zero cost and with no structural changes needed.

ACTIVITIES WE DO ON BED — Photo Documentation

A visual record of how the bed has become the default surface for every aspect of life



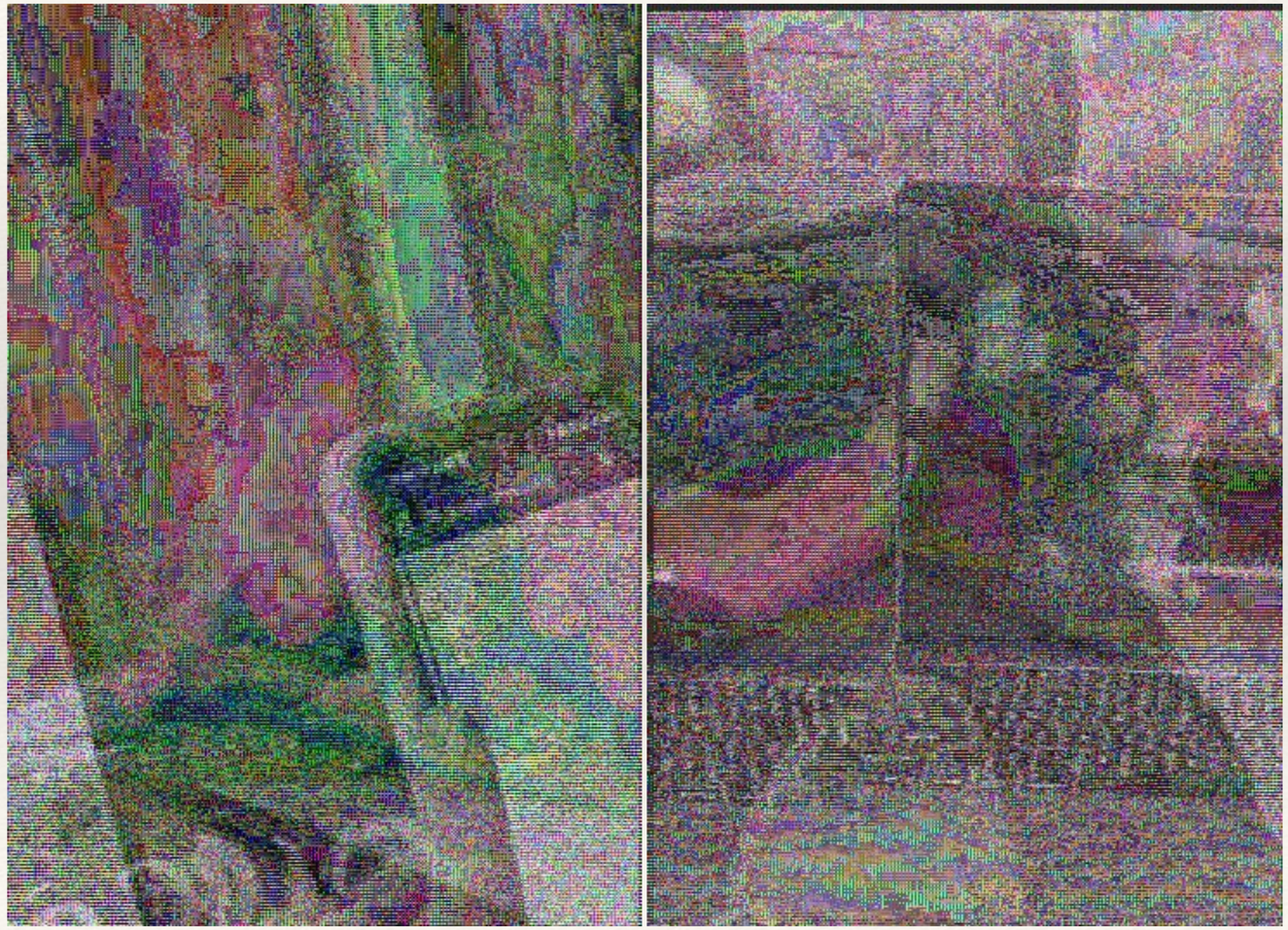
ZERO Psychological or Physical Friction in the Environment

means the transition from work to rest never happens.

A deliberate, unavoidable transition state is what is currently missing. Both primary and secondary data confirm: people complain about symptoms but do not diagnose bed behaviour as the problem.

Movie night in bed + doomscrolling on phone, the brain cannot tell the difference →

THE IRONY: The Bed Was Designed to Lower Arousal.
It is now used to INCREASE arousal through dopamine. It was meant to reduce stress. It now delivers stress **disguised as self-care.**



DEVELOPMENT & TESTING

Gap Identification · Opportunity Areas · Concept Exploration · Product Development · PSACampaign

“What creates an unavoidable, low-cost, permission-free transition that works inside a single room”

03

Gap Identification & Opportunity Areas

No designed transition between work and rest currently exists within a single-room living context.

WILLPOWER FAILS

Habit strength and dopamine reward loops are too powerful for behaviour change alone.

SPATIAL REDESIGN IMPOSSIBLE

Most users cannot move walls, add rooms, or change landlord fixtures. 117 sq ft is not negotiable.

APPS REQUIRE DISCIPLINE

Meditation and sleep apps demand consistent voluntary effort, exactly what is depleted by the lifestyle itself.

Three Intervention Territories

01

LIGHTING

The Zero-Cost Commute

Warm amber light as an end-of-day ritual. No space, no cost, no landlord permission. Signals the brain: work is over. The most immediately deployable intervention — changes behaviour without changing the room.

02

VISUALCUES

Mode-Shift Objects

A physical object or visible environmental change that signals mode shift even when the location does not change. Could be as simple as a folded item, a specific colour, or a deployed surface.

03

MODULAR DIVISION

Deployable Territory

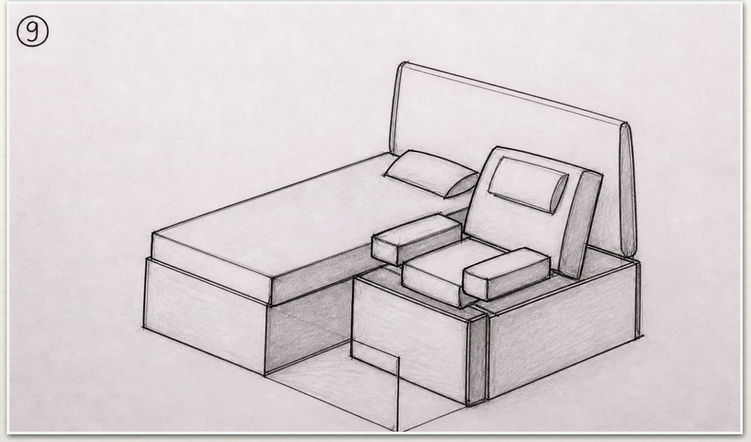
A product that physically separates the work zone from the rest zone within the same bed or room — without structural changes. The act of deploying it becomes the designed commute.

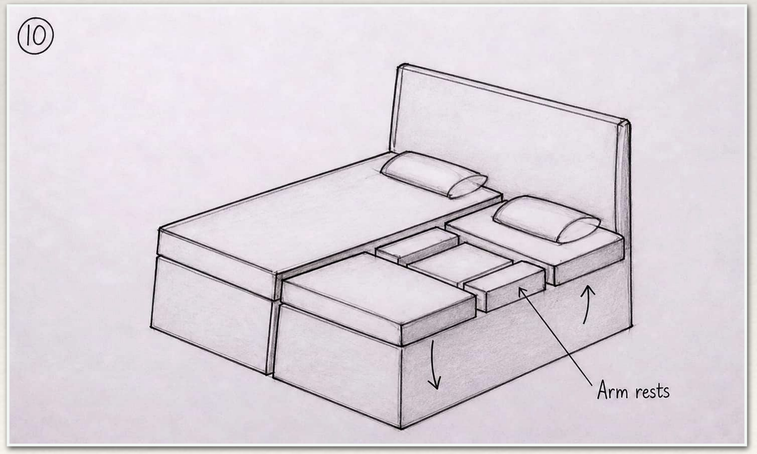
Concept & Transformation – PRODUCT

BED MODE

A wide platform system featuring integrated pop-up armrests and a stowed table mechanism. Designed for maximum surface area and comfort in compact dual-purpose living spaces.

- Panels lie horizontal
- Piston fully retracted
- Table stowed in central slot





CHAIR MODE

One side converts into individual seating with backrests and armrests. The table pivots out for work or dining, creating a functional living room arrangement from the bed frame.

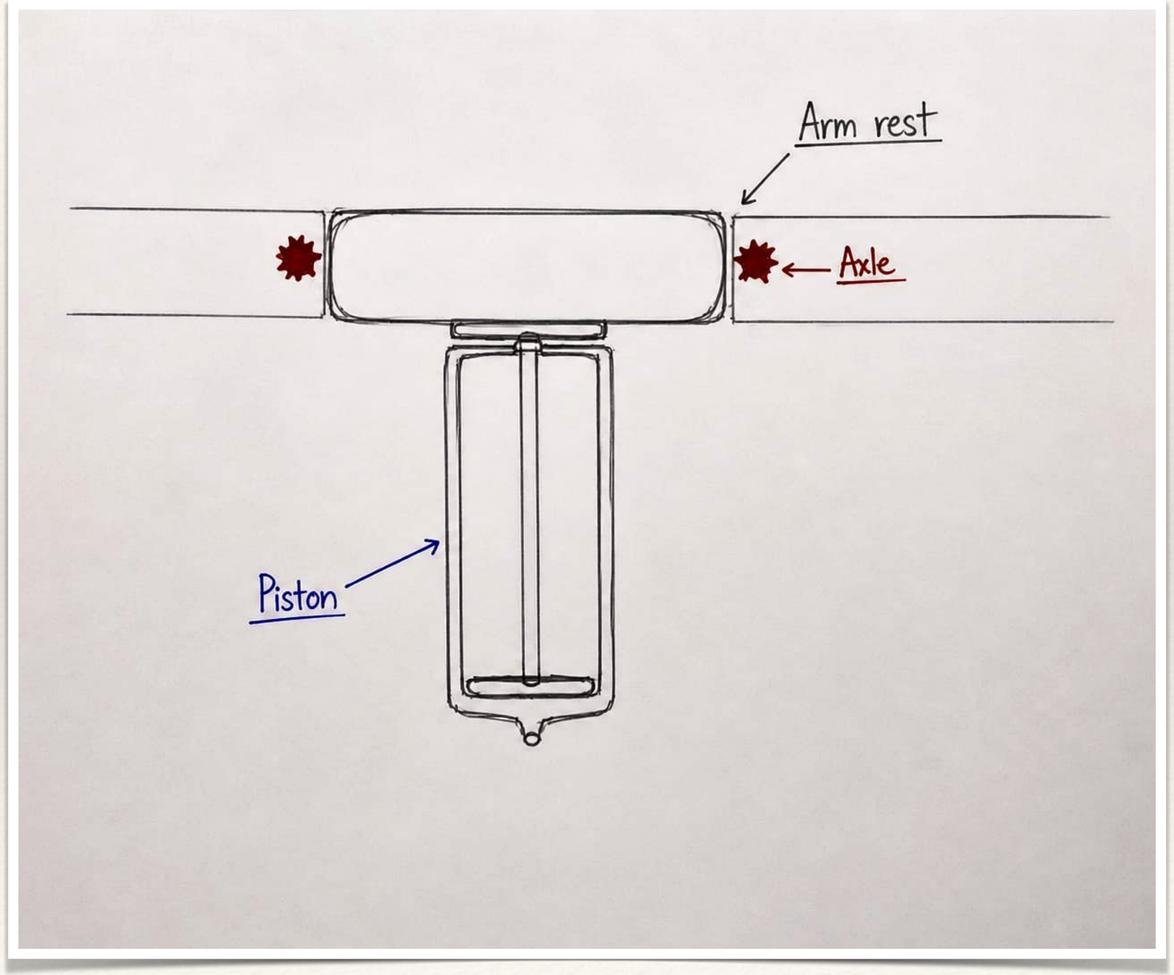
- Panels lock upright
- Piston fully extended
- Table deployed via central pivot

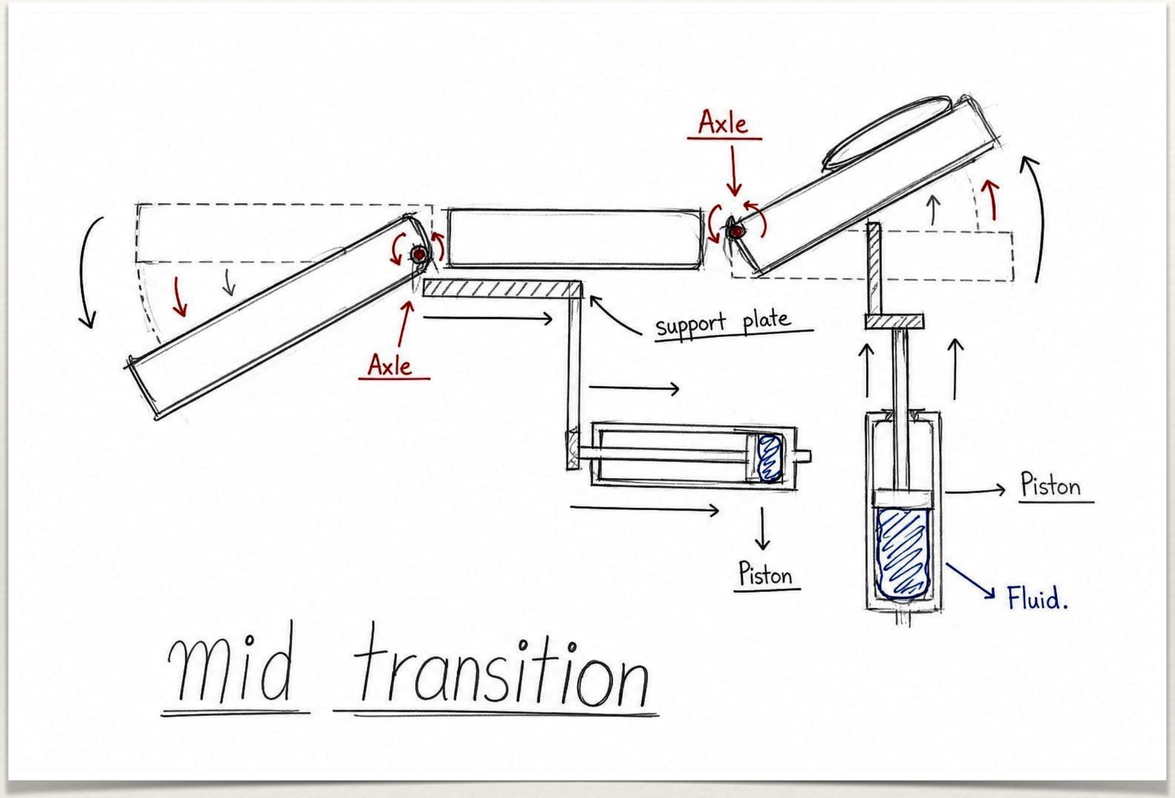
Mechanical Engineering

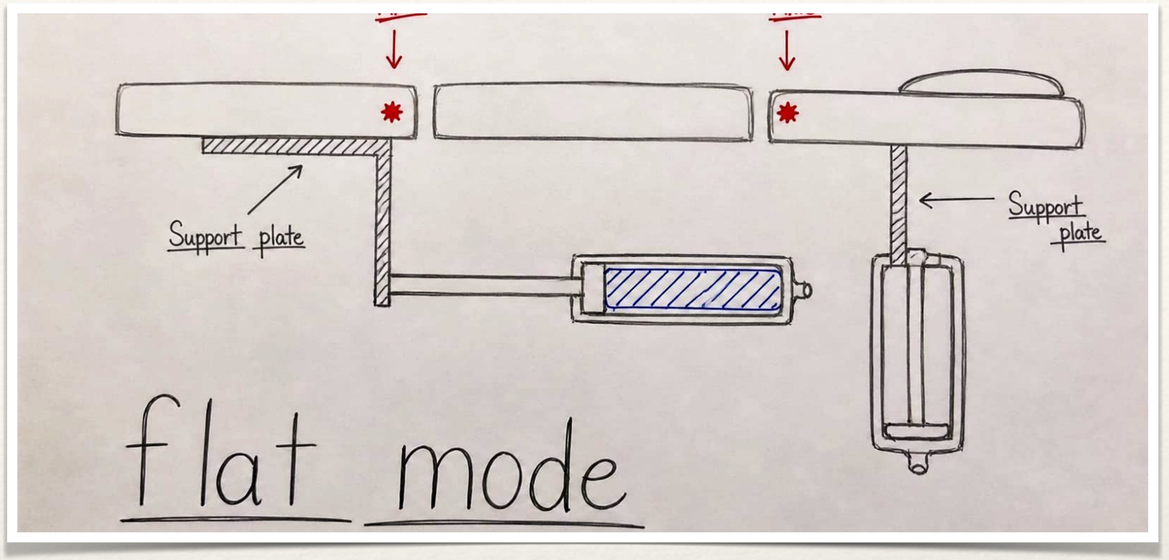
Core Axle + Piston System

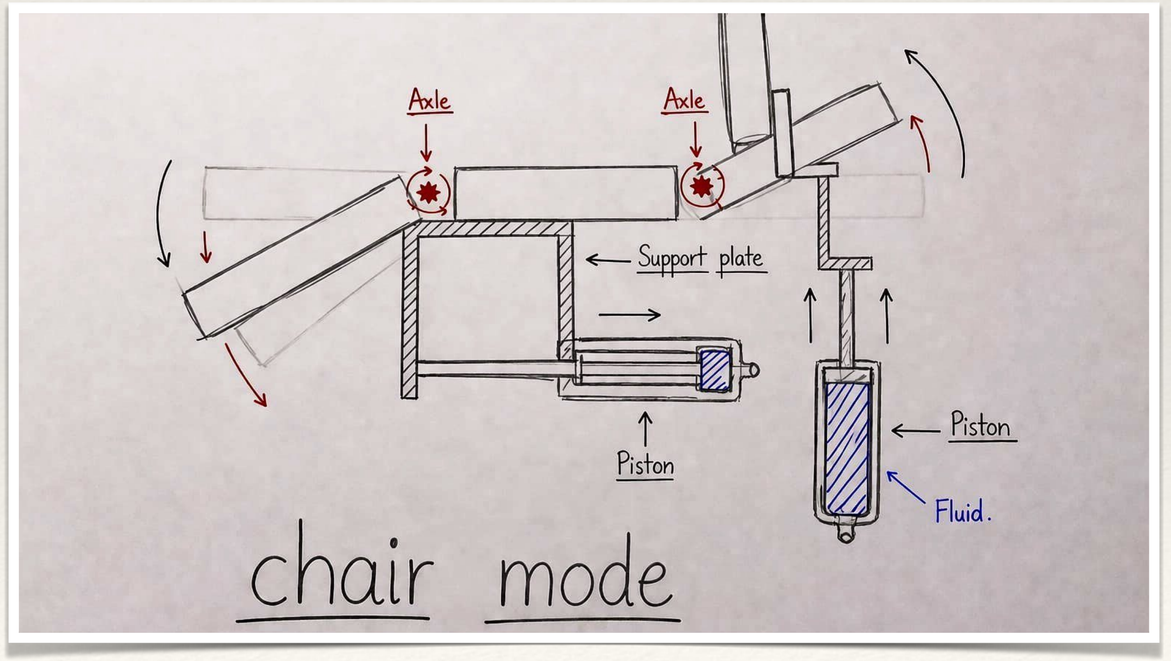
The transformation is driven by a sophisticated hydraulic circuit that manages weight distribution and structural integrity.

- Dual Axles: Precise pivot points for panel rotation.
- Hydraulic Pistons: Driving the transition with fluid compression.
- T-Shaped Rods: Independent vertical movement for armrest deployment.
- Safety Locking: Mechanical disc joints ensure stability in both configurations.




Axle
Axle
support plate
Piston
Piston
Fluid.
mid transition


Support plate
Support plate
flat mode


Axle
Axle
Support plate
Piston
Piston
Fluid.
chair mode

Material & Aesthetic Direction

NATURAL OAK

Used for frame edges and table surfaces. Matte oil finish to emphasize craftsmanship and warmth.





BOUCLÉ WEAVE

Soft, textured upholstery in greige/sand tones. Cloud-like comfort that contrasts with the hard frame.





BRUSHED METAL

Anodized aluminum for mechanical joints. Provides an honest, industrial-minimal accent.

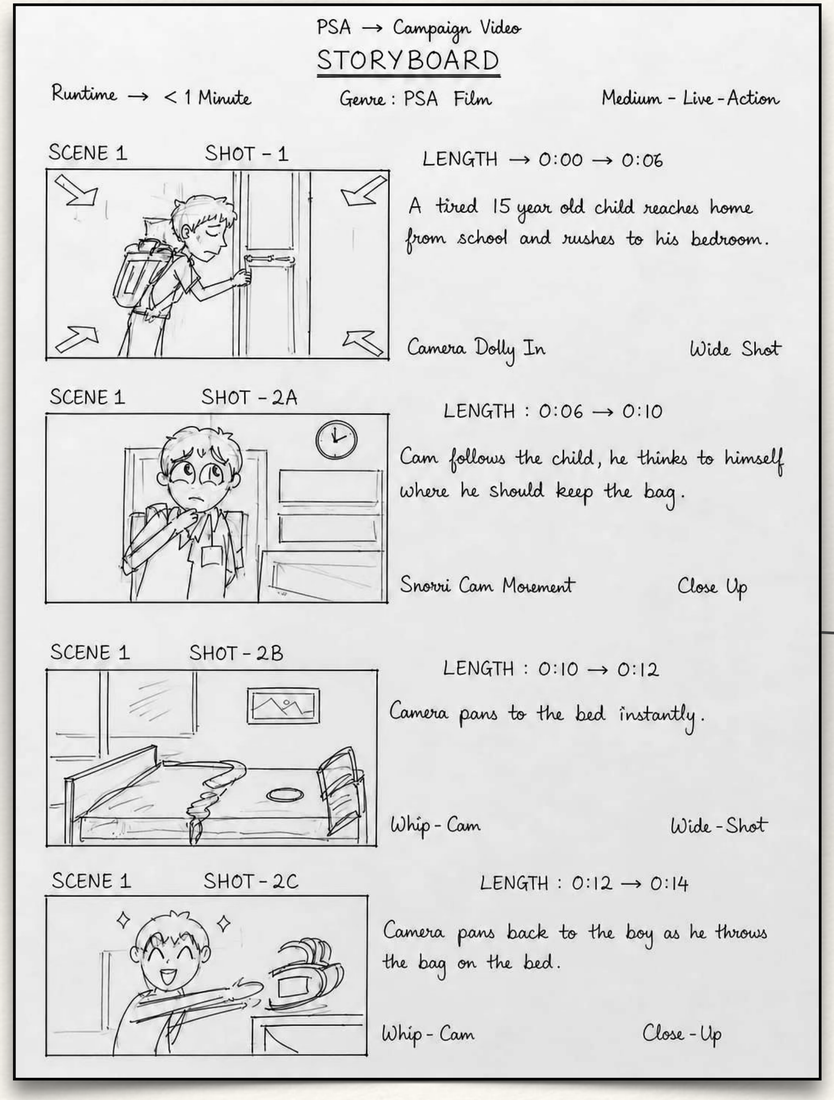




Source: Pallasmaa, J. (2005). "The Eyes of the Skin: Architecture and the Senses."

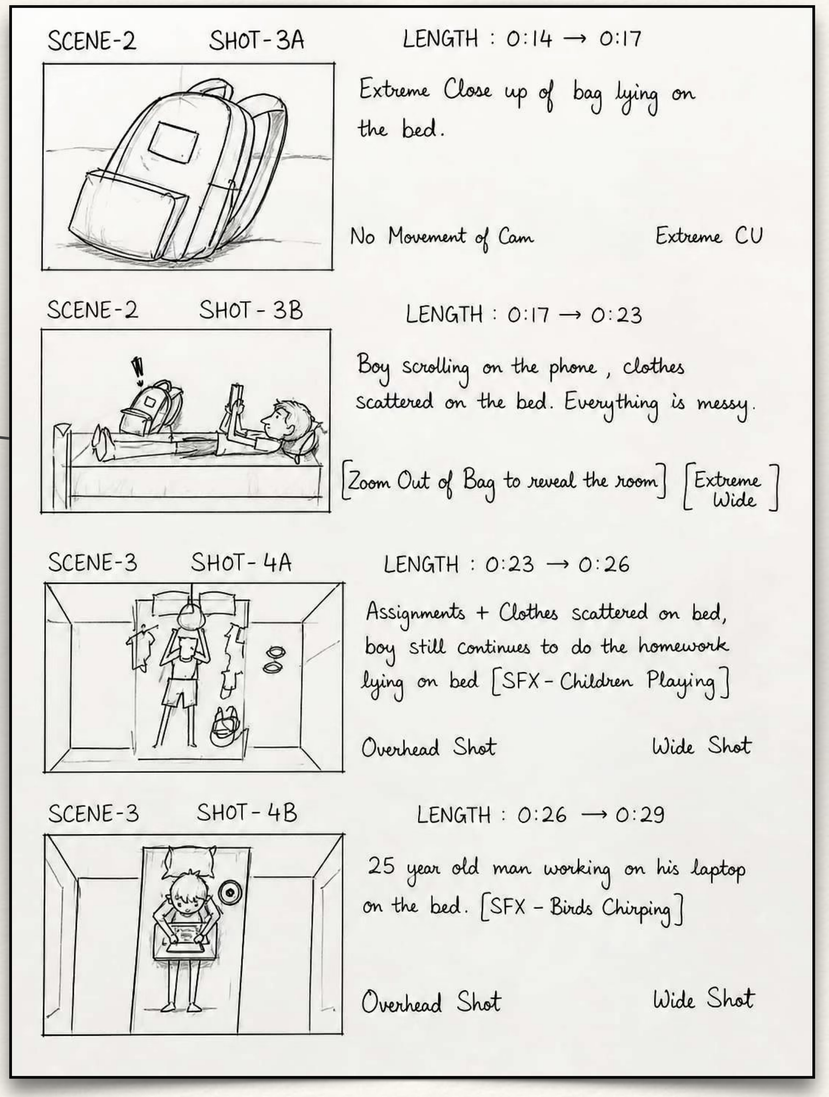
PSA Campaign Film – STORYBOARD

Live-Action · Under 1 Minute · Cross-Age Montage · Overhead Perspective



0:00–0:14
ARRIVAL
A tired 15-year-old arrives home.
Whip cam pans from child to bed.
He throws his bag onto the bed.

0:14–0:23
HABIT REVEALED
Extreme close-up: bag on bed.
Zoom out reveals scrolling phone, scattered clothes ,pure chaos.



PSA Campaign Film — STORYBOARD

PSA → Campaign Video

STORYBOARD

Runtime → < 1 Minute Genre : PSA Film Medium - Live-Action

SCENE-3 SHOT-4C

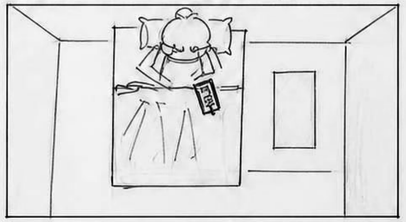


LENGTH : 0:29 → 0:32

40 year old snacking on chips, pizzas soft drinks on his bed. (SFX → Raining)

Overhead Shot Wide Shot

SCENE-3 SHOT-4D



LENGTH : 0:32 → 0:35

60 year old woman watching TV on her bed (SFX →TV Show bg)

Overhead Shot Wide Shot

From 0:35 ⟶ 0:39 ⟶ Intercut Fast between overhead views of all ages

SCENE-4 SHOT-5

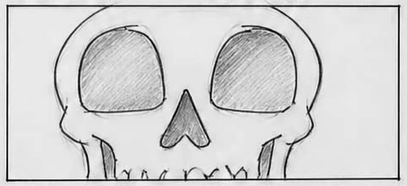


LENGTH : 0:39 → 0:42

Match Cuts between eyes of each age group.

No Movement Extreme Close Up

SCENE-4 SHOT-6A



LENGTH : 0:42 → 0:45

Match Cut ends at close up of a skull's eye

No Movement Extreme Close Up

0:23–0:39

CROSS-AGE MONTAGE

Overhead:

child doing homework on bed →

25yr man on laptop →

40yr snacking →

60yr watching TV.

Room progressively messier.

0:39–0:55

CLIMAX — THE SKULL

Match cuts between tired eyes of

each age.

Final cut: a skull lies on the same bed

The endpoint.

SCENE-4 SHOT-6B

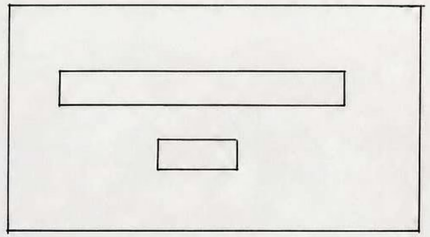
LENGTH : 0:45 → 0:50



Zoom Out from skull to reveal that it's lying on the same bed

Overhead Shot Extreme Wide

LENGTH : 0:50 ⟶ 0:55



Message at the end (Text) (Callout)

- Notes for the first Montage → [OVERHEAD]
- Light Zoom In throughout the whole video
- Room gets messier with each video
- Light Riser before the climax. [SOUND]

DESIGN INTENT

The Arm Hub creates a deployable micro-workspace that is physically distinct from the flat bed surface **without requiring extra room.**

"The act of extending or folding the Arm Hub becomes the designed commute: a physical action that tells the brain the mode has changed."

STUDENTS (18–24)
Hostel & family homes. Comfort and lack of space drive bed use equally.

EARLY CAREER(25–32)
Shared flats & studios. Comfort dominates, knowing better doesn't help.

ESTABLISHED (33–40)
Economic & spatial constraints. Simply not seen as a priority yet.

What Happens Next?

01 **USER TESTING — LIGHTING**

Do participantsalreadyuse secondarylamps, candles, or phone warmth settings as wind-down signals? If so, they've discovered the solution independently — design around it.

02 **MICRO-RITUAL MAPPING**

Whatspatialtricksdoindividualscurrently use to mentally separate work from rest? Document these and design with them, not against them.

03 **ARM HUB PROTOTYPE**

Developphysicalprototypeandtest against all three user segments — hostel student, flat sharer, family home. Iterate based on feedback.

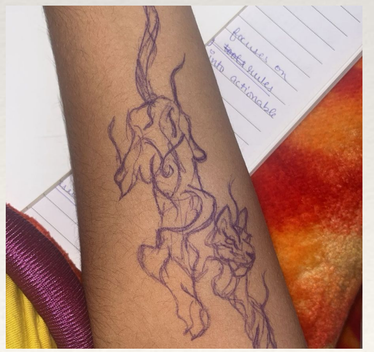
04 **PSA FILM PRODUCTION**

Finaliseend-slatemessagingwithteam. Shoot the cross-age montage. Real locations, real beds, real mess — no staged sets.

05 **LIGHTING PILOT TEST**

Testwarmamberlightingasstandalone zero-cost designed transition. Measure perceived transition quality before/after in same participants.







Closing

THE BED WAS NEVER MEANT FOR THIS.



The Everything Space · Design Research Project · 2025–26
Phases 1 through 3 — Problem Identification, Research & Analysis, Development & Testing

A life lived on the bed — documented

Secondary Research: Literature Review & Data Sources

- **PSYCOLOGICAL & BIOLOGICAL SOURCES**
  - **Bedtime Procrastination:** Kroese, F. M., et al. (2014). "Bedtime procrastination: A self-regulation problem."Frontiers in Psychology.
  - **The Blue Light Effect:** Harvard Medical School (2019; updated 2025). "Screen Time and the Brain." * **Circadian Rhythms & Melatonin:** Dr. Andrew Huberman (2025). "How Does Blue Light & Other Light Affect Your Sleep?"Huberman Lab Research.
  - **Conditioned Arousal:** Stepanski, E. J., & Wyatt, J. K. (2003). "Use of stimulus control instructions for the treatment of insomnia." Sleep Medicine Reviews.
- **URBAN & SOCIOLOGICAL SOURCES (INDIA CONTEXT)**
  - **Urban Spatial Constraints:** Swar's Research (2025). "India WFH Research: Urban Living Space Constraints (117 sq ft)."
  - **WFH Burnout:** LSE Business Review (2024) / DeskTime Remote Work Stats. *"83% Burnout Rate in Shared Indian Homes."*
  - **The "Entertainment Festival" Effect:** Resmed (2026). "Global Sleep Survey: 2026 Adult Findings on Screen Interference."
  - **Youth Habits in India:** BBC News (April 2025). "Screen time in bed linked to worse sleep: Study of 45,000 university students."
- **DESIGN & HEALTH SOURCES**
  - **Ergonomic Impact:** Kritika & Vikrant (2026). "Ergonomic Strain: Musculoskeletal Damage and Jaw Tension in Bed-Centric Lifestyles."
  - **Sensory Design Theory:** Pallasmaa, J. (2005). "The Eyes of the Skin: Architecture and the Senses" (Used for the Bouclé/Metal materiality section).
  - **Remote Work Infrastructure:** Microsoft (2022). "New Future of Work Report: Pandemic Origins of Bed-Working."